PREMIER LOGISTICS

Company Policies

Customer, Shipment, Warehouse, Financial & Fleet Operations Policy Manual

Premier Logistics Division · SwiftHaul Logistics & Transportation Pvt. Ltd.

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1. Purpose, Scope & Applicability

This Policy Manual sets out the official operating policies of SwiftHaul Logistics & Transportation Pvt. Ltd. ("the Company") governing how customer accounts, freight shipments, warehousing, cargo release, invoicing, quotations, fleet operations, and delivery are managed across the Company's logistics platform.

These policies apply to all Company employees, contracted drivers, warehouse staff, sales and finance personnel, and any automated systems (including the Company's AI customer service assistant) that read from or act upon Company operational data. Where an automated system is involved, it must operate within the boundaries defined here; it does not have authority beyond what is granted to a human employee in an equivalent role.

These policies are binding company-wide. Departmental procedures (see the companion Standard Operating Procedures document) must not conflict with the policies stated here; where a conflict exists, this Policy Manual takes precedence.

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2. Customer Account Policy

2.1 Account Eligibility & Registration

- A customer account is created only after collecting a valid company/individual name, a working contact channel (email or phone), and a service address.
- Each customer is issued a unique customer_code used as the reference for all future shipments, invoices, warehouse receipts, and quotations.

2.2 Account Status

- Accounts are maintained in one of three states: Active, Inactive, or Suspended.
- An account is moved to Suspended for repeated non-payment, fraudulent activity, or a documented compliance violation. Suspension decisions are made by Finance or Operations management, not by front-line staff or automated systems.
- A Suspended account may not book new shipments or receive new quotations until reinstated by an authorized manager.

2.3 Account Data Accuracy

- Customers are responsible for keeping contact and billing details current; the Company will use the most recently confirmed details on file for all communications and invoicing.
- Any request to change core account details (company name, billing address) must be verified against the account owner before being applied.

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3. Freight & Shipment Policy

3.1 Shipment Modes & Service Levels

- The Company offers four transportation modes: Air, Ocean, Road, and Rail. Mode selection is confirmed at booking and recorded against the shipment.
- Delivery priority levels are Standard, Express, and Overnight. Priority level affects routing and cost but does not override capacity or safety constraints.

3.2 Shipment Lifecycle & Status

- Every shipment progresses through defined statuses: Pending → In Transit → Delivered, with Delayed applied whenever the shipment falls behind its preferred_delivery_date.
- Status changes must be logged with a timestamp and location in the shipment's status history; verbal or informal status updates that are not entered into the system are not considered official.

3.3 Cargo Insurance

- Customers are offered optional cargo insurance at booking. Insured shipments are flagged accordingly, and claims for loss or damage are only payable for shipments where insurance was purchased and confirmed prior to pickup.

3.4 Package & Address Accuracy

- Each shipment must have complete pickup, delivery, and (where applicable) billing addresses recorded before dispatch. Incomplete address records are grounds for holding a shipment pending customer clarification.
- Declared package weights, volumes, and values must reflect the actual cargo; under-declaration for cost reasons is prohibited and may void insurance coverage.

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4. Warehouse & Inventory Policy

4.1 Receiving Goods

- All incoming goods must be logged as a warehouse receipt at the time of physical entry, recording the entry date, warehouse location, and an itemized packing list.
- Goods are not considered "in Company custody" until a warehouse receipt has been generated and confirmed.

4.2 Storage Status & Duration

- Warehouse receipts are tracked as Stored, Released, or In Transit. Storage status must reflect the physical location of the goods at all times.
- Standard free storage duration and applicable storage/demurrage charges beyond that period are set out in the Company Rules document (Section 7).

4.3 Stock Integrity

- Any discrepancy between recorded inventory and physical stock (shortage, damage, misplacement) must be reported to a Warehouse Supervisor the same day it is discovered and logged as an incident.

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5. Cargo Release Policy

5.1 Authorization Requirement

- Cargo may leave warehouse custody only after a cargo release record has been created and formally authorized by a designated employee. No goods are released on verbal instruction alone.
- Release authorization requires verification of the carrier or consignee identity (name, and where applicable, driver license number and PRO/tracking number) before goods are handed over.

5.2 Release States

- Cargo release records move through Pending → Approved → Released. Goods must not be handed over while a release is in Pending status.
- A release is only considered complete once the release_date and recipient details are recorded in the system.

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6. Invoicing & Payment Policy

6.1 Invoice Generation

- Invoices are generated per shipment (or consolidated per customer billing cycle where agreed) and must itemize subtotal, applicable taxes, any discounts, and the resulting total amount payable.
- Every invoice carries a due date; standard payment terms are defined in the Company Rules document (Section 4).

6.2 Payment Status Tracking

- Invoices are tracked as Unpaid, Partially Paid, Paid, or Overdue. Payment status must be updated immediately upon confirmed receipt of funds, not on promise of payment.
- Partial payments are logged individually with payment method and reference; the balance due is recalculated automatically after each recorded payment.

6.3 Disputes & Adjustments

- Any adjustment to an issued invoice (correction, discount, waiver, refund) must be approved by Finance management and recorded with a reason. Front-line staff and automated systems may not alter invoice totals independently.

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7. Quotation & Pricing Policy

7.1 Quote Issuance

- Quotations are prepared using current rate tables for the requested mode of transportation, route, and cargo profile, and must state applicable Incoterms (e.g., FOB, CIF, EXW, DDP) where relevant to the shipment type.
- A quotation is not a binding commitment until it is Accepted by the customer while still within its validity window.

7.2 Quote Status Lifecycle

- Quotations progress through Draft → Sent → Accepted / Expired / Rejected. Expired quotations must be reissued rather than honored at stale pricing, except where a manager approves an exception.

7.3 Custom & Negotiated Pricing

- Any pricing outside the standard rate table (bulk contracts, negotiated discounts) requires sign-off from Sales management and is documented against the quotation record.

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8. Fleet, Driver & Vehicle Policy

8.1 Driver Assignment

- Drivers are assigned to shipments based on licensing, route familiarity, and duty status (On Duty / Off Duty / In Transit). A driver may not be assigned to a shipment while already marked In Transit on another job.

8.2 Vehicle Standards

- Vehicles are classified by type (Trailer, Box Truck, Van) and must not be assigned cargo exceeding their recorded capacity_tons.
- A vehicle marked "Maintenance" may not be dispatched until its status is updated to "Available" following inspection sign-off.

8.3 Driver Personal Data

- Driver personal information (license numbers, contact details, home address) is Company-confidential and is handled per the Data Privacy & Confidentiality Policy (Section 10).

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9. Delivery & Proof of Delivery Policy

9.1 Delivery Completion

- A shipment is marked Delivered only after a delivery report is filed by the assigned driver recording the outcome (Success, Failed, or Attempted), timestamp, and recipient acknowledgement where available.

9.2 Delays & Failed Deliveries

- Any delay is logged with delay minutes and a reason where known. Failed or attempted deliveries trigger a redelivery workflow coordinated by Dispatch; goods are not returned to general stock without a logged reason.

9.3 Proof of Delivery (POD)

- POD (recipient name, signature, or equivalent confirmation) is retained against the delivery report and is the authoritative record for any delivery dispute.

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10. Data Privacy & Confidentiality Policy

10.1 Customer Data

- Customer account, shipment, and financial data is confidential and is disclosed only to the account owner or Company staff with a legitimate operational need.
- Customer data is never shared with another customer, an unrelated third party, or used for purposes outside fulfilling the Company's logistics services, without the customer's explicit consent.

10.2 Personnel Data

- Employee and driver personal data (identification numbers, contact details, performance records) is restricted to HR, direct management, and systems with an explicit operational need — never disclosed externally without authorization.

10.3 Systems & Automated Access

- Any system — including the Company's AI assistant — that queries customer or personnel data must operate on a least-privilege, read-first basis and must not expose internal identifiers, cost data, or personnel details beyond what this policy allows for the requester's role.

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11. Policy Governance, Review & Amendment

- This Policy Manual is owned by Company Operations Management and is reviewed at minimum annually, or whenever the underlying database schema, service offerings, or regulatory environment materially changes.
- Amendments require sign-off from Operations, Finance, and Compliance leads before taking effect.
- The current version supersedes all prior versions; staff and systems should always reference the latest published version.